

out. Replace weak links in a controlled order: secure the account, add the new recovery method, test it, save recovery codes where offered and only then remove the old connection.

Step 2: Assign email addresses by risk

Email addresses are among the strongest identity connectors because they are used for login, recovery, receipts and communication. Use a dedicated address for your legal and financial compartment, and do not publish it. Use another for professional activity, another for personal communication and aliases for low-value commercial registrations.

An alias can receive mail without exposing the underlying mailbox. Apple's Hide My Email creates random addresses that forward messages to the user's inbox and can be managed from Apple Account settings. Other providers offer aliases or forwarding addresses. Check whether replies reveal the destination address.

Follow this procedure for a new compartment:

1. Create the mailbox or alias from a trusted device.
2. Give it a neutral name unrelated to another compartment.
3. Use a unique password stored in a password manager.
4. Enable the strongest multi-factor authentication available.
5. Add a recovery method that does not publicly expose another identity.
6. Record the address, purpose and recovery details in your private identity map.
7. Send a test message and verify recovery before relying on it.

Avoid building a circular recovery chain in which Account A recovers through B and B recovers through A. A failure or takeover can then affect both. Google recommends a recovery email different from the sign-in address and allows recovery phone and email details to be reviewed or changed in account settings.

Step 3: Separate browser sessions

Different email addresses are insufficient when every account shares one browser session. Cookies, logins, history and accidental account switching can join activities or cause posts from the wrong identity.

For strong everyday separation, create a different browser profile for each major compartment. Chrome states that profiles keep information such as bookmarks, history, passwords and settings separate, and specifically presents them as a way to separate work and personal accounts. However, profiles on the same unlocked device are not access-control boundaries; someone who can use the device may be able to switch profiles.

Use this setup:

1. Create profiles named by purpose, such as Legal, Work, Personal and Public.
2. Give each a visibly different theme or profile icon.
3. Sign in only to accounts belonging to that compartment.

4. Install only extensions genuinely required for that role.
5. Configure downloads into separate folders.
6. Pin the correct profile shortcut to the desktop or taskbar.
7. Close one profile before beginning sensitive work in another.
8. Never use "continue with" a personal account inside a pseudonymous compartment.

Firefox Multi-Account Containers can divide browsing into labelled container tabs for activities such as work, banking, shopping and personal use, and can keep multiple logins to the same site separated. They are useful for convenience and cookie separation, but a full browser profile is easier to reason about when bookmarks, extensions, history and settings must also differ.



A separate desktop workspace is not automatically a separate identity. For higher-risk separation, consider distinct operating-system accounts or dedicated devices, balanced against cost and complexity.

Step 4: Break username and image reuse

A rare username can function like a fingerprint, connecting every site on which it appears. Do not create pseudonyms by adding one digit to your usual handle.

Generate a different naming pattern for each compartment. Avoid initials, birth years, PIN codes, vehicle numbers, hometown references and favourite phrases already associated with you. Store usernames in your password manager so you do not need memorable similarities.

Apply the same rule to images. Do not reuse a headshot, logo or cropped photograph across identities. For a pseudonymous account, create a purpose-specific avatar that neither resembles a personal photograph nor copies another person's image.

Step 5: Control phone-number and payment bridges

Phone numbers are persistent, widely used for recovery and often connected to verified identity. Do not treat an alternate SIM as anonymous. Use lawfully registered numbers and comply with KYC requirements.